Mohammadreza Hashemi

Ecosystem Strategy Manager | Strategic Business Development

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Executive Summary

Ecosystem strategy and business development executive with 12+ years designing, launching, and scaling innovation and entrepreneurship programs at national and regional levels. Executive Secretary and Project Manager of the regional #ai404 program, and Co-Founder & Project Manager of the Silk Road Startup international program, delivered across 12 Iranian cities with broad participation from domestic startups; proven track record leading multi-stakeholder partnerships across the private sector, government bodies, and the entrepreneurial ecosystem. Co-founder of Hamfekr Mashhad, the largest entrepreneurship community in eastern Iran, built on a Community-Led Growth model. Experienced leading customer support and Voice of Customer (VoC) programs on a 40M-user platform (Neshan), applying a Dual-Track Agile model to identify and resolve user issues in parallel across support, product, and engineering teams — driving measurable improvements in platform user experience. Skilled in designing and executing business growth strategies grounded in market insight and professional networks, with a consistent focus on measurable outcomes.

Core Competencies

Ecosystem Strategy & Program Design · Strategic Partnerships & Stakeholder Management · Community-Led Growth · Cross-Functional & Cross-Organizational Leadership · Large-Scale Program & Event Execution · Customer Experience (CX) Strategy & VoC Programs

Executive & Leadership Experience

#ai404 | Executive Secretary & Project Manager — June 2025 – January 2026

An upgraded, Startup Weekend-format program focused on artificial intelligence; co-organized by Hamfekr Mashhad and Khorasan Science & Technology Park, in partnership with the Iran AI Association

- Designed and delivered AI404, an AI-focused Startup Weekend event (an evolved format of the classic Startup Weekend), bringing in Khorasan Science & Technology Park as co-organizing partner alongside Hamfekr Mashhad; led a 20-person organizing team as Executive Secretary
- Expanded the program's geographic reach: attracted 110 participants from 5 provinces and engaged 11 specialist mentors at the national level
- Managed execution and budget: oversaw a cash and in-kind budget exceeding 500M Toman, covering 4 pre-events across 4 Mashhad universities, 2 specialized workshops at Ferdowsi University, and a 3-day flagship event
- Scaled the event's reach: delivered an opening ceremony attended by 500 AI and entrepreneurship professionals at Ferdowsi University of Mashhad

Neshan Maps & Navigation | Community Lead & Customer Support Manager — February 2023 – May 2025

Iran's leading maps and navigation platform, serving 40M+ users

Community Lead | February 2023 – March 2024

- Designed and launched a pilot user community for Neshan (modeled on the Google Local Guides mechanism); organized strategic networking events in Tehran and Mashhad and managed the program's launch campaign
- Recommended a timely, well-reasoned decision to discontinue the initiative, based on a cost-benefit analysis, market timing assessment, and pilot-phase results, to prevent further investment of company resources

Customer Support Manager | March 2024 – May 2025

- Redesigned the operating structure and aligned cross-functional teams; established an integrated workflow across Support, Product, and Engineering by implementing a Dual-Track Agile model
- Reduced First Response Time (FRT) by 30% by leading process improvements and CRM system development, optimizing communication channels, and managing the capacity of a 5-person team to resolve all multichannel user requests within 5 business days, even during nationwide peak-demand periods
- Designed and directed the Voice of Customer (VoC) and competitive intelligence program; managed the budget and structured execution of monthly NPS surveys (reaching ~200,000 unique users per wave), ongoing competitor monitoring, and quarterly studies; delivered strategic reports and analysis directly to the CEO and senior leadership to inform product decisions

Mashhad Innovation Factory | Executive Operations Manager — 2019–2022 (Operator: Ferdowsi Mashhad Accelerator)

The largest innovation hub in eastern Iran (10,000 sqm), featuring co-working space, tech company offices, a lab, and event spaces

- Contributed to the hub's initial launch and shaped its resident mix (startups, growth-stage tech companies, and key players in Mashhad's entrepreneurial ecosystem); managed day-to-day operations of the co-working space, dedicated offices, and event venues
- Designed, ran, and supported specialized entrepreneurship programs focused on knowledge transfer and synergy, alongside curating the hub's own event series; facilitated 20+ specialized technology and entrepreneurship events annually
- Facilitated engagement among the private sector, government bodies, universities, and Mashhad's technology holding companies through joint sessions addressing ecosystem challenges and opportunities

Silk Road Startup Program | Co-Founder & Project Manager — 2017–2019

Iran's first international program to identify, accelerate, and showcase the country's top startups to the entrepreneurial community and to domestic and global investors, delivered entirely in English (each cycle comprised a Road Trip to identify and select startups, a 100-day online acceleration track led by leading Iranian and international experts for finalist teams, and a two-day final event bringing together key entrepreneurs from Iran and abroad)

- Project management, team coordination, and resource acquisition: managed execution of two program cycles alongside 7 co-founders; provided integrated coordination across media, communications, infrastructure, logistics, sponsorship, and provincial leads, and organized a nationwide network of 100+ specialist volunteers; contributed, together with the founding team and sponsorship lead, to securing 78 strategic sponsors (including Snapp, Lian Capital, Alibaba, Digikala, and Flytoday), and managed cash/in-kind resources equivalent to ~$75K (at the exchange rate of that period), including $10K–15K in deals closed personally, in collaboration with the Vice Presidency for Science and Technology, major Iranian startups, and VC firms
- National execution and startup sourcing: led operational delivery of a 9,000-kilometer Road Trip across 12 provincial hubs, working alongside logistics leads and local coordinators; attracted 680 applicant teams, evaluated and selected 144 teams, and advanced 24 teams to the final stage, with 7,000+ total participants across both program cycles
- Acceleration and mentoring network: developed and managed the #Silkroad100 process, a 100-day, equity-free acceleration program, in collaboration with the acceleration program lead; facilitated mentoring engagements between 32 domestic and international mentors and finalist teams
- International expert network: built and managed a network of 71 speakers and judges from 16 countries, with international experts engaged at every layer of the program — from the judging panels of the provincial Road Trips through the acceleration track and the final event

Hamfekr Mashhad | Co-Founder & Community Development Lead — 2014–Present

The largest entrepreneurship and startup community in eastern Iran (Mashhad)

- Founded and grew Hamfekr Mashhad from a single networking event into the largest entrepreneurship community in eastern Iran; 3,500+ members and 197 events held to date
- Engaged 96 distinct host organizations (companies, startups, universities, accelerators, innovation centers, and the provincial Science & Technology Park) to facilitate professional connections and create a networking platform for specialists, mentors, and investors
- Developed a personalized partnership model with event hosts; designed customized packages spanning Employer Branding, targeted Talent access, and Brand Activation, aimed at creating synergy with Mashhad's entrepreneurial ecosystem and generating a revenue stream to sustain and improve the quality of Hamfekr Mashhad's events

Recognition & Professional Endorsements

- Recommended by Hossein Bakhshaei (Co-Founder & Strategy Executive, Neshan) for his ability to build meaningful relationships and deliver outstanding results in customer service
- Received a recognition award from Dr. Sorena Sattari (then Vice President for Science and Technology of Iran) at the Yalda Summit (December 2018), in acknowledgment of his contribution to developing Iran's entrepreneurship and startup ecosystem; Elias Khosravi, Co-Founder of Hamfekr Mashhad, was separately recognized at the same ceremony

Education & Professional Certifications

M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence | Islamic Azad University, Mashhad Branch

B.Sc. in Software Engineering | Imam Reza International University

Certificate: “Business Development To Grow Through Strategic Relationships” — Coursera (expected completion: 2026)

Languages

Persian (Native), English (Fluent)